particularly care for Mr Modi either, but this did not mean I would necessarily excuse or be an apologist for comparable crimes committed by other parties or politicians. In my book I had done what I thought was the historian's duty, but this had now come back to haunt, and possibly doom, the campaign to save the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library. *

In the end, Professor Mukherjee was granted an extension of two years. A senior official in the prime minister's office I spoke to said that the PM recognized the intellectual force of our argument—the mistake we had apparently made was to mention the portraits of the Congress prime ministers in the foyer and the fact that the NMML had been home to Youth Congress meetings. This permitted the director and her supporters to—*pace* Mr Dev—represent us as somehow being against the interests of the Congress party (and its First Family). Members of Parliament who were office-bearers of the Youth Congress had also met the prime minister to press the director's case. Meanwhile, as with the controversial selection of Pratibha Patil as the President of India, criticisms of one of her appointees made Sonia Gandhi even more determined to protect her protégé. The Congress party, and its president

especially, valued loyalty and length of service above all other virtues and characteristics. In India in general, and in this regime in particular, loyalty would take precedence over scholarship and institution-building, any time.

Soon after the director of the NMML had been granted a new term, the institution announced that it would hold a month-long celebration 'to commemorate the 120th birth anniversary of Jawaharlal Nehru'. A festival of films, inaugurated by the Congress chief minister of Delhi, purported to show how 'Bombay cinema took Nehru's vision of secularism to the masses and popularized it'. A seminar on Nehru's impact on Indian architecture was organized, where one speaker claimed that 'Jawaharlal Nehru wanted the buildings to reflect what he stood for … He was probably the last "ruler" in Delhi who has had a great impact on the architecture of his times and his city since Shahjahan.' Other seminars celebrated the 'Nehru